MEGATREND FIELD NOTE

Resilience becomes a permanent strategy setting

Structural · Evidence current to 27 August 2026

Executive thesis

Resilience has moved from contingency planning into the base design of strategy. Trade and investment continue, but the routes, legal instruments, energy exposure, technology controls and financing conditions around them are changing. A plan built on one stable geopolitical and macroeconomic path is therefore fragile. The strategic response is not indiscriminate duplication; it is to create economically disciplined options that let the company switch suppliers, routes, funding sources and market emphasis when predefined triggers occur.

The numbers that anchor the view

31 vs 13 OECD countries screening inbound investment in 2023 versus 2010, as reported in the Weekly Brief archive. [1]	**4.6% to 1.9%** WTO baseline change in merchandise-trade volume growth from 2025 to the 2026 forecast; 2027 is forecast at 2.6%. [2]
2.5% World Bank forecast for global growth in 2026, down from 2.9% in 2025, with downside risks emphasized. [3]	**2.9%** annual long-term global trade growth cited in the Brief archive, illustrating that rewiring can coexist with continued expansion. [4]

How the signal evolved, 2023-2026

2023-24 · Risk enters the CEO agenda

The Briefs move from general geopolitical concern to explicit exposure mapping, scenario planning and investment-screening constraints. Companies begin treating policy and trade rules as operating variables. [1][4]

2025 · Networks rewire rather than retreat

Evidence points to new hubs, route changes and differentiated country strategies rather than a uniform reversal of global trade. Resilience is increasingly measured through alternatives and recovery time. [4][5]

2026 · Multiple futures become the planning norm

The archive formalizes scenario-based strategy while multilateral outlooks describe slower growth, weaker trade momentum and material downside risks. Optionality becomes an asset with an explicit cost and return. [6][3][2]

How the trend creates - or destroys - value

Policy changes market access

Investment screening, export controls, sanctions and local requirements can alter who may own, supply or finance an asset. The exposure often sits beyond the first-tier supplier. [1][7]

Energy and logistics transmit shocks

Conflict or infrastructure disruption reaches earnings through energy prices, freight, working capital and customer demand. The same event can benefit one corridor while damaging another. [8][9]

Options have portfolio value

Dual sourcing, alternative routes, modular capacity and liquidity appear inefficient in a static base case but can protect throughput and strategic freedom when conditions change. Their value must be compared with the probability-weighted earnings at risk. [6][10]

Economic logic

Resilience spending should be treated as a portfolio of options, not an undifferentiated insurance premium. For each critical exposure, management can estimate disruption probability, time to recover, margin at risk and the cost of an alternative. This distinguishes valuable optionality from complexity. A second supplier with no qualified capacity, a route that shares the same port or a duplicated plant dependent on the same technology does not create true resilience. The economic objective is to reduce correlated failure while preserving enough scale to remain competitive in the base case. [4][1][5]

Implications by stakeholder

Strategy Replace a single forecast with a small set of decision-relevant scenarios, each linked to triggers, owners and pre-agreed moves.	**Operations** Map common points of failure across suppliers, ports, energy, data, technology and financing rather than counting alternatives.
Capital Price flexibility, liquidity and modular capacity as strategic assets and compare their cost with earnings at risk.	

CEO action agenda

NEXT 90 DAYS **Identify concentrated exposures** Map the ten exposures that could interrupt critical revenue or production for the longest period, including second- and third-order dependencies.	**NEXT 90 DAYS** **Define trigger points** Agree observable policy, market, logistics and energy indicators that would activate a different operating or capital response.
6-12 MONTHS **Build real alternatives** Qualify suppliers, routes, financing and production options before they are needed and test whether they avoid common failure points.	**6-12 MONTHS** **Rebalance the portfolio** Use country and asset reviews to reduce correlated exposure while preserving attractive growth options.

What could break the thesis

- Trade can continue to expand despite political friction, making excessive localization economically destructive.
- Redundant capacity can become permanent cost if triggers and exit rules are unclear.
- Scenario planning can create false confidence when it does not change pre-committed decisions.

Indicators to monitor

• Earnings at risk by scenario
• Time to recover for critical flows
• Qualified alternative capacity
• Share of exposures with trigger-based playbooks
• Correlation of supplier and infrastructure dependencies

Evidence boundary and confidence

High that volatility is a planning assumption; medium on the direction of individual trade corridors The evidence supports rewiring and diversification, not a generalized collapse of globalization or a universal case for near-shoring.

Sources and traceability

[1] Weekly Brief · 2024-06-24 · How to Face Rising Geopolitical Risk

[2] Authoritative research · WTO · 2026-03-19 · Global Trade Outlook and Statistics — March 2026 · p. 4

[3] Authoritative research · World Bank · 2026-06-16 · Global Economic Prospects — June 2026 · p. 25

[4] Weekly Brief · 2025-01-14 · Navigating the New Dynamics of Global Trade

[5] Authoritative research · WTO · 2025-12-15 · Global Value Chain Development Report 2025: Rewiring GVCs in a Changing Global Economy

[6] Weekly Brief · 2026-04-21 · Beyond Tomorrow—Four Scenarios for the World of 2050

[7] Authoritative research · World Economic Forum · 2026-01-14 · Global Risks Report 2026

[8] Authoritative research · IMF · 2026-07-08 · World Economic Outlook Update: Global Economy in Crosscurrents of War and Technology

[9] Authoritative research · J.P. Morgan Global Research · 2026-07-01 · Mid-Year Market Outlook 2026: The Tug of War Continues

[10] Weekly Brief · 2026-03-24 · Infrastructure Investing Is Back

[11] Weekly Brief · 2025-08-28 · Reflections from India—A Country Defining Its Future

[12] Weekly Brief · 2024-09-25 · The Draghi Report—What Business Leaders Need to Know

Independent synthesis of the available Weekly Brief archive and selected authoritative research. Forecasts, survey results and company-reported figures are identified by their source; they are not presented as audited actuals. The website retains the complete underlying Brief and research lists.